NextPhases.dev

ORGANISATION MASTER PLAN

Engineering your next phase of success

Version 1.0 | February 2026 | Lusaka, Zambia

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1. Who We Are

NextPhases.dev is a student-founded software development team based in Lusaka, Zambia. We build scalable digital solutions for startups, freelancers, businesses, and cultural/civic organisations. We are in the process of formal registration as a Private Limited Company (Ltd) with PACRA and operate under the domain nextphases.dev.

Our work spans three pillars:

- Client Services — web development, app development, and technical consulting
- Internal Products — original software built under the NextPhases brand (e.g. Nsolo, ExamGuard)
- Community & Representation — ICTAZ student chapter involvement and regional tech ecosystem participation

Location: Lusaka, Zambia | Website: nextphases.dev | team@nextphases.dev

2. Team Structure

NextPhases operates with a flat structure. Everyone is a co-founder. Roles reflect current strengths and availability, not hierarchy. Roles may evolve as the team grows.

Name	Title	Responsibilities	Workload
Thuma	Lead Developer & Secretary	Lead all development work, project architecture, Nsolo project owner, ICTAZ student chapter secretary, content/PM support	**High**
Simon	Full-Stack Dev & Business Lead	ExamGuard project owner, assist in client dev work, handle client communication & pitching alongside Chris, PACRA registration liaison	**High**
Chris	Client Relations Lead	Primary client contact, onboarding, communication, maintaining client relationships, assist Simon in pitching	**Medium**
Shaun	Junior Developer (Mobile UI)	Mobile/responsive UI tasks, lower-priority dev assignments, stepping back from media management	**Low–Medium**
Lans	Associate Contributor (Informal)	Attends team meetings when available, takes on tasks if present and willing. No formal pay until actively contributing.	**Informal**

2.1 Suggested Pay Structure (Per Project)

Pay is distributed as a percentage of net project revenue, after any tool/hosting costs are deducted. Rates reflect role contribution and effort per project.

Member	Role Weight	Suggested Cut	Notes
Thuma	Lead Dev	**30–35%**	Higher if leading full dev of project
Simon	Dev + Biz	**25–30%**	Higher if also doing client comms

Member	Role Weight	Suggested Cut	Notes
Chris	Client Lead	**15–20%**	Scales with client acquisition effort
Shaun	Junior Dev	**10–15%**	Only on projects he contributes to
Lans	Contributor	**0–5%**	Only if actively contributed to project
Team Reserve	Operations	**5–10%**	Goes to team fund for tools, costs

Always agree on cuts before starting a project. Write it in a simple message to the group for record. Formal contracts for larger projects.

3. Email Infrastructure

All emails use the @nextphases.dev domain via ImprovMX (free plan). The free plan supports up to 10 aliases forwarding to personal Gmail/email accounts. No email hosting needed — just forwarding.

ImprovMX Free Plan: Up to 10 aliases, forwarding only (no sending from alias unless using Gmail SMTP workaround — see setup guide below).

Email Address	Purpose	Usage Guide
team@nextphases.dev	General / Primary	Main inbox. Use for all client-facing communication, contracts, official correspondence. Everyone should monitor this.
hello@nextphases.dev	New Enquiries	Public-facing. Put on website, social media, business cards. Forwards to team@. Keeps team@ cleaner.
thuma@nextphases.dev	Thuma (Personal Work)	For project-specific threads, dev discussions, ICTAZ-related correspondence.
simon@nextphases.dev	Simon (Personal Work)	For ExamGuard dev, business/PACRA comms, sponsor outreach.
chris@nextphases.dev	Chris (Client Lead)	For client relationship management, follow-ups, onboarding threads.
shaun@nextphases.dev	Shaun (Dev)	For dev task comms when needed. Low priority to set up — can wait.
noreply@nextphases.dev	System Emails	For automated emails from the website contact form or future app notifications. Never monitored.

Setup: Send As @nextphases.dev from Gmail (Free)

- In ImprovMX, add alias and point it to your Gmail
- In Gmail Settings > Accounts > Add another email address
- Enter your @nextphases.dev address, use Gmail SMTP (smtp.gmail.com, port 587)
- Use an App Password from your Google account (not your normal password)
- Now you can send AND receive as your @nextphases.dev address inside Gmail — free

Priority setup order: team@ → hello@ → thuma@ → simon@ → chris@. Shaun@ and noreply@ can wait.

4. Legal & Business Setup

4.1 PACRA Registration

NextPhases should register as a Private Limited Company (Ltd) with PACRA. This is the recommended entity type for a team-based tech company.

Why Private Limited (Ltd)?

- Separates personal assets from business liability
- Looks more professional to clients and sponsors — 'NextPhases Ltd' on contracts
- All founders can be listed as directors/shareholders
- Required to open a proper business bank account
- Better positioned for sponsorships, grants, and formal partnerships

Action Items:

- Simon to lead PACRA registration process (consult family guidance)
- Prepare: full names of all directors, registered address (can use a team member's address), company name 'NextPhases Ltd' or 'NextPhases Development Ltd'
- PACRA website: pacra.org.zm — check current registration fees
- Once registered, open a business bank account (Zanaco or Stanbic recommended for ZMW + USD accounts)

Do not sign any client contracts with significant value until PACRA registration is complete.

4.2 Regional Pricing Model

NextPhases charges based on the client's region, not a single global rate. This reflects purchasing power parity and local market rates.

Region	Currency	Example Rate (Small Site)	Notes
Zambia / Africa	ZMW	**ZMW 2,000–8,000**	Affordable for local market. Can also quote in USD at local rate.
South Africa	ZAR	**ZAR 3,000–12,000**	Stronger economy, higher rates justified.
UK / Europe	GBP / EUR	**GBP 500–2,000+**	Quote at UK/EU freelance market rates.
USA / Canada	USD	**USD 500–3,000+**	Quote at US freelance market rates.
Other Regions	USD	**Negotiate**	Default to USD for neutral international currency.

There is no legal requirement to charge in one currency in Zambia. Charging per region is standard practice for international freelancers. Always state currency clearly in contracts.

4.3 Business Communication

- SIM Card: Get a dedicated NextPhases SIM for WhatsApp Business + voice calls with clients
- WhatsApp Business: Set up with company name, logo, business hours, and auto-reply
- Phone number to be listed on website and contracts once active
- Simon is leading sponsorship outreach — keep team updated via WhatsApp group

5. Internal Products

NextPhases develops original products that serve as both portfolio pieces and potential revenue sources. Each product is owned and led by one team member to ensure accountability and full-stack learning.

5.1 Nsolo — Digital Zambian Board Game

Owner	Thuma (solo project)
Status	v1.1.0 — Desktop app complete (Java/Swing). JAR + EXE packaged. Private GitHub repo under NextPhasesDev org.
Tech Stack	Java (Swing) — desktop. Web version planned in JS/TypeScript.
Repo	github.com/NextPhasesDev (private)
Next Milestone	v2.0.0 — Web version playable at nextphases.dev/nsolo
Site Dependency	nextphases.dev/nsolo page needed before domain is 'complete'
Revenue Potential	Free-to-play web version. Future: premium desktop download, cultural licensing.

5.2 ExamGuard — Invigilator App

Owner	Simon
Status	Working prototype exists. In active development.
Tech Stack	TBD by Simon
Purpose	Digital tool for exam invigilators — attendance, incident reporting, time management.
Target Users	Schools, universities, exam bodies in Zambia and regionally.
Next Milestone	Simon to define — recommend setting v1.0 scope and timeline
Revenue Potential	SaaS licensing to institutions. Freemium model possible.

Both products serve as portfolio anchors. Neither should be rushed. Quality > speed. Showcase them on nextphases.dev once ready.

6. Website Roadmap — nextphases.dev

The site is live at nextphases.dev. Core structure is built. Below are outstanding tasks prioritised by impact.

✅Done: Domain live, homepage built, contact form sending to team@, services/portfolio/testimonials sections exist (empty), dark mode, nav, responsive design.

Task	Priority	Owner	When
Wire up contact form to real backend (Formspree recommended)	HIGH	Thuma	Immediately
Activate social media accounts (LinkedIn, GitHub, Instagram)	HIGH	Chris / Simon	This month
Uncomment social links in footer (index.html)	LOW	Thuma	After accounts live
Set up WhatsApp Business number on site	HIGH	Simon	After SIM acquired
Portfolio section — add Nsolo + ExamGuard as first entries	HIGH	Thuma + Simon	When products ready
Team/About page — photos, bios, roles	MEDIUM	All	Phase 2
Testimonials section — first client testimonial	MEDIUM	Chris	After first client
Mobile UI polish (nav, forms, cards)	MEDIUM	Shaun	Ongoing
Blog / Dev Diary page	LOW	Thuma	Phase 3
Nsolo web embed at nextphases.dev/nsolo	HIGH	Thuma	When Nsolo v2.0 ready
Add regional pricing page or calculator	LOW	TBD	Phase 3
Migrate from GitHub Pages to Vercel (if needed for backend)	MEDIUM	Thuma	When backend needed

⚠ Do not purchase additional domains or expand to multi-page until Nsolo web version is deployable and contact form backend is wired up.

7. Client Workflow

Every client engagement follows this 8-stage process. Consistency protects the team and impresses clients.

#	Stage	What Happens	Who	Action / Notes
1	**Lead Comes In**	hello@ or team@ receives enquiry / Chris or Simon spots opportunity	Chris / Simon	Log in Notion Leads DB. Acknowledge within 24hrs.
2	**Discovery Call / Meeting**	Understand client needs, scope, timeline, budget	Chris (lead) + Simon or Thuma	Take notes. Use Client Onboarding Checklist from Drive.
3	**Proposal Sent**	Create proposal doc using template. Include scope, timeline, pricing.	Thuma (dev scope) + Chris (delivery)	Save in Drive: 02_Client_Work > [Client] > 01_Contract_&_Scope
4	**Agreement Signed**	Client signs service agreement. Collect 50% deposit.	Chris	Use Client_Contract_Template.gdoc. Invoice via Invoice Template.gsheet.
5	**Development**	Build the project. Weekly check-ins with client.	Thuma / Simon / Shaun	Work in Drive: 03_Work_In_Progress. Use GitHub for code.
6	**Review & Revisions**	Share staging link. Collect feedback. Max 2 revision rounds.	Thuma + Chris	Log feedback in Notion project page.
7	**Final Delivery**	Deploy. Send final files. Collect remaining 50%.	Thuma (deploy) + Chris (invoice)	Move to Drive: 04_Final_Deliverable. Close Notion task.
8	**Post-Project**	Follow up in 2 weeks. Ask for testimonial. Log for portfolio.	Chris	Add to testimonials on site when received.

Always take a 50% deposit before starting work. No exceptions. This protects the team from unpaid work.

8. Notion Workspace — Daily Workflow

The Notion workspace is the single source of truth for NextPhases. WhatsApp is for quick chats. Notion is for everything that needs to be tracked, remembered, or shared formally.

8.1 Recommended Notion Structure

Set up these pages/databases in Notion:

Notion Page	What It Contains	Who Maintains It
□ **Home / Dashboard**	Quick links, current sprint tasks, announcements	Thuma
□ **Task Board (Kanban)**	All active tasks: To Do / In Progress / Review / Done. Assigned to team members.	Everyone
□ **Leads & Clients DB**	Client name, status, contact, project type, value, stage (pipeline)	Chris
□ **Projects DB**	One page per project. Links to Drive folder, GitHub repo, tasks, notes.	Project Owner
□ **Nsolo Dev Log**	Version history, build notes, roadmap, decisions made	Thuma
□ **ExamGuard Dev Log**	Same as above for ExamGuard	Simon
□ **Meeting Minutes**	Notes from team meetings. Date-stamped.	Thuma (Secretary)
□ **Finance Tracker**	Link to Google Sheet Income Tracker. Log payments received.	Thuma / Simon
□ **Team Reference**	This master plan summary, email guide, role reference, quick rules	Thuma
□ **Site Roadmap**	Website tasks with status, owner, priority (mirrors Section 6 of this doc)	Thuma

8.2 Daily / Weekly Workflow

When	What to Do
Every Day	Check WhatsApp group for urgent messages. Check Notion Task Board — move cards if status changed. Check team@ email if you're on duty.
Every Week (Monday)	Quick WhatsApp check-in: each person posts 1 update on what they're working on. Thuma updates Task Board. Chris checks Leads DB — any follow-ups needed?
Every 2 Weeks	Team meeting (in-person or WhatsApp call). Review progress, blockers, upcoming tasks. Thuma records minutes in Notion.

When	What to Do
Per Project	Create a project page in Notion. Assign tasks. Link Drive folder. Update status as work progresses.
Per Client	Add to Leads & Clients DB immediately when contact is made. Update stage after every interaction.
Monthly	Review Finance Tracker. Check if any tools need renewing. Simon updates on PACRA / sponsorship progress.

Rule: If it was discussed on WhatsApp and it's a decision, task, or plan — it goes into Notion within 24 hours. WhatsApp is not a to-do list.

9. Notion Visual Mockup

Below is a text-based mockup of how the Notion sidebar and home page should look. Use this as your setup guide when cleaning up the workspace.

9.1 Sidebar Structure

```
□ NEXTPHASES WORKSPACE
├── □ Home Dashboard
├── □ Task Board  ← Main kanban
├── □ Leads & Clients
├── □ Projects
│     ├── □ Nsolo
│     ├── □ ExamGuard
│     └── [Client Projects]
├── □ Meeting Minutes
├── □ Finance
├── □ Site Roadmap
└── □ Team Reference
```

9.2 Home Dashboard Layout

The Home page should have these sections in order:

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────┐ │  NextPhases.dev  |  [Month
Year]            | ├──────────────────────────────────────────────┤ │  □ THIS
WEEK'S FOCUS                        | |  (Manual text — update Monday)
| ├──────────────────────────────────────────────┤ |  □ MY TASKS  (filtered view
of Task Board) | |  Each person sees their assigned tasks        |
├──────────────────────────────────────────────┤ |  □ ACTIVE CLIENTS / LEADS
| |  (Linked from Leads & Clients DB)             |
├──────────────────────────────────────────────┤ |  □ QUICK LINKS
| |  Google Drive | GitHub | nextphases.dev      | |  team@nextphases.dev |
Invoice Template      | └──────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

9.3 Task Board — Kanban Columns

□ BACKLOG	□ TO DO	□ IN PROGRESS	□ REVIEW	✅DONE
Ideas & future tasks not yet scheduled	Assigned, not started yet	Currently being worked on	Needs checking / approval	Completed & verified

□ Each task card should have: Title, Assigned To, Due Date, Project Link, Priority (High/Med/Low). Keep it simple — don't over-engineer Notion.

10. Goals & Milestones

10.1 2026 Goals

Quarter	Goal	Owner	Status
Q1 2026	Complete PACRA registration as NextPhases Ltd	Simon	In Progress
Q1 2026	Wire up contact form backend (Formspree)	Thuma	Pending
Q1 2026	Get NextPhases SIM card (WhatsApp Business + calls)	Simon	Pending
Q1 2026	Set up all priority email aliases (ImprovMX)	Thuma	Partially Done
Q1 2026	Land first paid client (any size — first ZMW in counts)	Chris / Simon	In Progress (BICCDP lead warm)
Q2 2026	Nsolo v2.0 web version live at nextphases.dev/nsolo	Thuma	In Dev
Q2 2026	ExamGuard v1.0 scope defined and in development	Simon	Prototype exists
Q2 2026	Social media accounts live (LinkedIn + Instagram min)	Chris / Simon	Pending
Q2 2026	Portfolio section on site populated (Nsolo + ExamGuard)	Thuma + Simon	Pending
Q3 2026	First testimonial on website	Chris	Pending
Q3 2026	Secure at least 1 sponsor or grant	Simon	In Progress
Q4 2026	ZMW 500+ revenue earned as a team	All	Target
Q4 2026	Team/About page live on site	All	Pending

10.2 Financial Goal

2026 Target: Earn first revenue as a team. Even ZMW 500 counts. The goal is to break even on any tools/costs and prove the model works. Every kwacha earned is a milestone.

Revenue can come from:

- Client web/app projects (primary)
- Sponsorship (Simon leading)
- Future: Nsolo / ExamGuard premium features or licensing

11. Quick Reference — Team Rules

This page is for everyone. Print it, pin it, send it on WhatsApp. These are the things everyone should know.

The Golden Rules

- If it's a decision — it goes in Notion.
- If it's a task — it goes on the Task Board with your name on it.
- If it's client-related — Chris is first point of contact.
- If it's a contract — 50% upfront. Always.
- If you're stuck — say so in WhatsApp immediately. Don't go quiet.
- If you're going to miss a deadline — tell the team 48 hours early.

Who Does What (Quick Version)

Person	Go-To For...
Thuma	All development questions, GitHub, site code, Nsolo, ICTAZ matters, meeting minutes
Simon	ExamGuard, client pitching, PACRA/legal, sponsorship, business development
Chris	Client communication, onboarding, relationships, post-project follow-up
Shaun	Mobile UI tasks, responsive design, lower-priority frontend work

Key Links & Tools

Resource	Where / How to Access
Website	nextphases.dev (live)
GitHub Org	github.com/NextPhasesDev
Google Drive	Shared team drive — ask Thuma for access if missing
Email (Primary)	team@nextphases.dev — everyone should be forwarding to personal Gmail
Email (Public)	hello@nextphases.dev — for website / marketing
Notion	Team workspace — ask Thuma for invite link
Hosting	Netlify (connected to NextPhasesDev GitHub org)
Email Aliases	ImprovMX (improvmx.com) — Thuma manages
Contracts Template	Google Drive: 01_Administration > Contracts_&_Legal
Invoice Template	Google Drive: 05_Resources > Templates > Invoice Template.gsheet

This document should be reviewed and updated every quarter. Owner: Thuma.